

Chapter 119-9

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It wasn't until right before bed that Liang Shi remembered to check the trending searches. The buzz around her and Yan Xi's CP had already died down.

But late at night, Liang Shi scrolled past a familiar name: Chen Liuying.

The hashtag was #Chen Liuying's Artistic Photos Are So Alpha#.

Liang Shi originally didn't really want to click on it, but her finger slipped and she clicked in. At the very top was Chen Liuying's Weibo post.

She still had a few die-hard fans, but most were cursing at her.

The photos were actually taken quite well—black and white tones, very atmospheric. You could tell at a glance they had the quality of a magazine spread.

Combined with her looks, if she hadn't caused trouble, she really could have done quite well in the entertainment industry.

But she just had to stir up that whole incident, and now all her endorsements and drama contracts were gone.

Liang Shi hadn't seen her or Bai Weiwei since then. She only heard from Xu Qingzhu that Bai Weiwei's family business had run into a crisis, so Bai Weiwei had returned to work at her family's company and left the entertainment industry.

Only Chen Liuying was left alone.

She didn't know what the status of their relationship was, but they had probably broken up.

Liang Shi couldn't help but sigh.

Though it wasn't undeserved.

For celebrities with dirt on them online, buying trending searches every now and then to boost their visibility, brushing up netizens' goodwill, and testing the waters to see if they could make a comeback—these were all very normal operations.

So Liang Shi could tell at a glance that this was Chen Liuying testing the waters.

But fans nowadays were incredibly shrewd—they understood the entertainment industry better than the celebrities themselves.

Chen Liuying's comment section had fallen within half an hour, filled with curses.

Basically everyone was telling her to get out of the entertainment industry.

Liang Shi originally wanted to exit. She couldn't stand seeing this kind of online backlash; it always reminded her of what happened to her back then.

But before she could tap out, she accidentally touched the screen and hit like—though she canceled it at the speed of light.

It still gave her quite a scare.

But this also reminded her that she should do what she used to do—use a side account when surfing online.

Otherwise, it was easy for things to go wrong.

For her, it was just an ordinary finger slip, but Chen Liuying happened to see it.

Chen Liuying stared at the #Oath# hashtag that was sitting right above her own hashtag. Seeing Liang Shi's name made her seethe with anger.

Those insulting comments kept popping up on her phone screen. She watched them in an almost self-torturing manner, her eyes dark with shadow.

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For Liang Shi, this was just a small incident in her daily life.

On the fifth day of filming, after Liang Shi wrapped up and got her phone, she received a message that came out of nowhere: [Tomorrow at ten, Riddle.]

It was from Chen Mian.

Liang Shi thought for a moment before understanding—this was an invitation to meet.

She replied: [You're back in the country?]

Chen Mian was brief and concise: [Mm.]

Liang Shi checked her schedule for tomorrow. Her scenes were all concentrated in the afternoon, so she could go out. She agreed to the meeting.

Early the next morning, Liang Shi got up, put on light makeup, and went to Riddle for the appointment.

She arrived at Riddle Café at 9:40, twenty minutes earlier than the agreed time. She went in, ordered a cup of coffee, and quietly waited for Chen Mian to arrive.

Chen Mian walked into the café right on time.

Because the original owner's memories contained this person, Liang Shi recognized her at a glance.

But the Chen Mian now was drastically different from the one in her memories.

Especially her face.

The Chen Mian in her memories wasn't considered very beautiful, but that teardrop mole was very alluring, and her eyes were the type that once you saw them, you couldn't forget them.

But the current Chen Mian still had the teardrop mole, only without such a strong sense of melancholy—replaced by a few degrees of aggression.

Chen Mian was wearing a black casual loungewear outfit, also with light makeup, French bangs, hair draped over her shoulders, dyed ink blue.

A very artistic hairstyle.

After sitting down, she swept a glance at Liang Shi and said familiarly: "You're not wearing those bizarre outfits of yours. Good."

Liang Shi: "..."

Obviously, she was referring to the original owner's dark history.

Liang Shi smiled awkwardly, didn't respond to that, and just looked at her gently.

Cold sunlight refracted through the huge floor-to-ceiling windows, falling on her somewhat sickly pale face.

She wasn't even this pale in her memories.

It was probably the result of not going outside for a long time.

"What do you want with me?" Chen Mian asked. "Is it for your little sister again?"

Before Liang Shi could deny it, Chen Mian scoffed to herself: "When will you ever come for your older sister?"

Her tone carried mockery.

Liang Shi paused. "I actually did come for an older sister this time."

When these two words came out of her mouth, they carried an inexplicable sense of familiarity.

Liang Shi stared at Chen Mian and said, word by word: "For Sister Qi Jiao."